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# R Programming: Importing Data Files into R

R is a powerful tool for data analysis and visualization; this guide will provide resources to get you started with this programming language!

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## Import Data from a File

Oftentimes, you would import data into R from a previously saved file.

### Importing data files using the Script Editor:

When importing data into R, save it as an object and give it a name using the `<-` assignment operator.

To import a tab delimited file, write the code: `tab_data <-`

```
read.table("filelocation/Intro To R/datafile.txt", sep = "")
```

- Be sure the file directory path is a forward slash (/), NOT a back slash (\).

To import a comma delimited file, write the code: `csv_data <-`

```
read.csv("filelocation/Intro To R/datafile.csv", sep = ",")
```

- Note that the argument `sep=` may not be necessary as R knows the separators are commas in .csv files and blank spaces in .txt files, but sometimes R won't read the data correctly unless you specify the separator.

Codes for other file types and functions/packages to 'read' in the data, ordered by usage popularity:

| Type of Data                   | File Extension         | R Code/Packages                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tabular data                   | .CSV                   | <code>read_csv()</code> function from the readr package                                           |
| Tabular data                   | .TSV                   | <code>read.table()</code> function from the readr package                                         |
| Text                           | .TXT                   | <code>readLines()</code> function<br>OR <code>read_lines()</code> function from the readr package |
| Excel                          | .XLSX                  | <code>read.xlsx()</code> from the xlsx package                                                    |
| Google sheets                  | Google URL or Sheet ID | <code>read_sheet()</code> from the googlesheets4 package                                          |
| SPSS statistical program file  | .SAS7BDAT or .SAS7BCAT | <code>read_sas()</code> from the haven package                                                    |
| SAS statistical program file   | .SAV                   | <code>read_sav()</code> from the haven package                                                    |
| Stata statistical program file | .DTA                   | <code>read_dta()</code> from the haven package                                                    |
| MySQL database                 | MySQL database files   | <code>dbConnect()</code> from the RMySQL package                                                  |
| Fixed-width text file          | .TXT                   | <code>read.fwf()</code> from the utils package                                                    |

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To load data into Posit Cloud, first upload the data set in the 'Files' pane. Upload the file into your 'cloud/project' folder.

In RStudio, click 'Import Dataset' in the top right Environment pane in your working session. Select options to import from Text, Excel, SPSS, SAS, or Stata files. Assign a short descriptive 'Name' to the data set.